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Inventor(s)	Shigenaga; Masato

Vehicle control device

Abstract

A vehicle control device mounted on a vehicle, includes: an automatic parking control unit that performs automatic parking control, and a non-contact charging control unit that performs non-contact charging control. Further, while the automatic parking control unit performs the automatic parking control, the non-contact charging control unit specifies radio communication information associated with a parking space of a parking target with reference to map information, and performs pairing between a power transmission device and a power receiving device by using the specified radio communication information.

Inventors:	Shigenaga; Masato (Utsunomiya, JP)
Applicant:	TOYOTA JIDOSHA KABUSHIKI KAISHA (Toyota, JP)
Family ID:	91447972
Assignee:	TOYOTA JIDOSHA KABUSHIKI KAISHA (Toyota, JP)
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Patent No.	Application Date	Country	CPC
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2020-049983	12/2019	JP	N/A

Primary Examiner: Yacob; Sisay

Attorney, Agent or Firm: Oliff PLC

Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATION(S)

(1) The present application claims priority to and incorporates by reference the entire contents of Japanese Patent Application No. 2022-200595 filed in Japan on Dec. 15, 2022.

BACKGROUND

(2) The present disclosure relates to a vehicle control device.

(3) According to Japanese Laid-open Patent Publication No. 2020-048250, in the communication between the vehicle and the power supply equipment, a plurality of power supply stands provided in the power supply equipment transmits a radio wave signal, when the vehicle receives a radio wave signal from a plurality of power supply stands, the vehicle control device, based on the reception strength and the reception direction of each radio wave signal it is disclosed to select a power supply stand to establish communication.

SUMMARY

(4) There is a need for providing a vehicle control device that can realize the pairing between the power transmission device on the ground side and the power receiving device on the vehicle side in a simple manner.

(5) According to an embodiment, a vehicle control device mounted on a vehicle includes: an automatic parking control unit that performs automatic parking control for automatically parking the vehicle in a parking space which is a parking target selected by a user of the vehicle from among a plurality of parking spaces provided in a parking lot, and a non-contact charging control

unit that performs non-contact charging control for transmitting power from a power transmission device installed in the parking space to a power receiving device provided in the vehicle in a non-contact manner and stores the power in a battery mounted on the vehicle. Further, while the automatic parking control unit performs the automatic parking control, the non-contact charging control unit specifies radio communication information associated with the parking space of the parking target with reference to map information, and performs pairing between the power transmission device and the power receiving device by using the specified radio communication information.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

- (1) FIG. 1 is a diagram schematically illustrating a non-contact charging system in the embodiment;
- (2) FIG. 2 is a block diagram for explaining a functional configuration of a vehicle ECU;
- (3) FIG. 3 is a diagram for explaining a parking space and the power transmission device;
- (4) FIG. 4 is a sequence diagram for explaining the control when the vehicle is automatically parked; and
- (5) FIG. 5 is a flowchart for explaining the control when the vehicle is automatically parked.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(6) In the configuration described in Japanese Laid-open Patent Publication No. 2020-048250, when selecting an arbitrary power supply stand from a plurality of power supply stands, it is necessary to provide a measurement rejection device separately from the communication device to each of the vehicle and a plurality of power supply stands since the cost increases.

(7) Hereinafter, a vehicle control apparatus according to an embodiment of the present disclosure will be specifically described. Note that the present disclosure is not limited to the embodiments described below.

(8) FIG. 1 is a schematic diagram illustrating a non-contact charging system in the embodiment. The non-contact charging system 1 includes a power supply facility 2 and a vehicle 3. The non-contact charging system 1 includes a wireless power transmission system that transmits power from the power supply facility 2 to the vehicle 3 in a non-contact manner. In the non-contact charging system 1, in a state where the vehicle 3 is stopped in the parking lot 4, the power receiving coil 21 of the power receiving device 20 in the vehicle 3 can receive the power transmitted in a non-contact manner from the power transmission coil 11 of the power transmission device 10.

(9) The power supply facility 2 is a facility for supplying power to the vehicle 3. The power supply equipment 2 is provided in the parking lot 4 such as commercial facilities and public facilities and accommodation facilities. The power supply facility 2 includes a power transmission device 10 and an AC power source 5 that supplies power to the power transmission device 10. The AC power supply 5 is a commercial power supply or a home power supply.

(10) The power transmission device 10 includes a power transmission unit 12 having a power transmission coil 11 and a box 13. The power transmission device 10 is installed in the parking space 6 of the parking lot 4. For example parking lot 4 has a plurality of parking spaces 6. In this case, the power transmission device 10 is installed for each parking space 6.

(11) Transmission unit 12 is installed on the ground in the parking space 6. The box 13 is located near the parking space 6, for example, a wall of the parking lot 4. The power transmission unit 12 and the box 13 are electrically connected. The power from the AC power source 5 is supplied to the power transmission unit 12. The transmission device 10 has a power conversion unit that converts the AC power supplied from the AC power source 5 into transmission power to output to the power transmission coil 11.

(12) Further, the power transmission device **10** includes a power transmission ECU **14** for controlling the power converting unit and a communication device **15** for communicating with the vehicles **3**. In the box **13**, the power transmission ECU **14** and the communication device **15** is provided.

(13) The power transmission ECU **14** includes a processor and a memory (main storage unit). The processor is composed of a Central Processing Unit (CPU), a Digital Signal Processor (DSP), an Field-Programmable Gate Array (FPGA), and a Graphics Processing Unit (GPU). The memory consists of a Random Access Memory (RAM) and a Read Only Memory (ROM). Signals from various sensors are inputted into the power transmission ECU **14**. The power transmission ECU **14** performs various controls based on signals inputted from various sensors. For example, the power transmission ECU **14** controls the switching elements included in the power converting unit to adjust the power for power transmission. The power transmission ECU **14** executes power transmission control for controlling power transmission of the power transmission device **10**. The power transmission ECU **14** executes communication control for controlling the communication of the communication device **15**.

(14) The communication device **15** performs wireless communication with the vehicle **3** to be parked in the parking space **6**. The communication device **15** transmits information from the power transmission ECU **14** to the vehicle **3** and receives information transmitted from the vehicle **3**. The communication device **15** is capable of wireless communication by, for example, Wi-Fi (registered trademark) or a wireless LAN. The communication device **15** outputs a radio signal as a short-range wireless communication targeting the vehicle **3** in the parking lot **4**.

(15) The vehicle **3** is an electric vehicle capable of charging power supplied from an external power source, for example, an electric vehicle (BEV) or plug-in hybrid vehicle (PHEV) and the like. The vehicle **3** is a vehicle capable of stopping in the parking space **6** in which the power transmission coil **11** is installed. The vehicle **3** includes a power receiving device **20**, a battery **22** for storing power received by the power receiving device **20**, a vehicle ECU **23** for controlling the vehicle **3**, a communication device **24**, and a display device **25**.

(16) The power receiving device **20** includes a power receiving coil **21**. The power receiving coil **21** receives the power transmitted from the power transmission coil **11** in a non-contact manner. The power receiving device **20** supplies the power received from the power transmission device **10** to the battery **22**. The power transmission device **10** and the battery **22** are electrically connected to each other.

(17) The battery **22** is an in-vehicle battery that can be externally charged. The battery **22** is constituted by a secondary battery for storing power supplied from the power receiving device **20**.

(18) The vehicle ECU **23** is a vehicle control device mounted on the vehicle **3**. The vehicle ECU **23** is configured in the same way as the power transmission ECU **14** as a hardware-based configuration. The vehicle ECU **23** executes various vehicle control based on signals input from various sensors mounted on the vehicle **3**, information acquired through communication using the communication device **24**, and information input through manipulation on the display device **25**.

(19) The communication device **24** performs wireless communication with an external device. The communication device **24** performs wireless communication with the communication device **15** of the power transmission device **10**. The communication device **24** transmits information from the vehicle **3** to the power transmission device **10** and receives information transmitted from the power transmission device **10** to the vehicle **3**. The communication device **24**, when the vehicle **3** is present in the parking lot **4**, receives a radio signal as short-range wireless communication transmitted from the power transmission device **10** in the parking lot **4**. That is, the communication device **24** includes a short-range communication device that enables short-range wireless communication and a far-range communication device that enables far-range wireless communication.

(20) The display device **25** is a device that functions as a display unit of the car navigation system.

The display device **25**, it is possible to display the map information corresponding to the current position of the vehicle **3**. The display device **25** also functions as an input unit for receiving an input operation from the user of the vehicle **3**. The displayed device **25** is controlled by the vehicle ECU **23**.

(21) As illustrated in FIG. **2**, the vehicle ECU **23** includes an automatic parking control unit **31**, and a non-contact charging control unit **32**. The automatic parking control unit **31** executes the automatic parking control for automatically parking the vehicle **3** in the parking space **6**. The non-contact charging control unit **32** transmits power from the power transmission coil **11** to the power receiving coil **21** in a non-contact manner, and executes the non-contact charging control for storing the power received by the power receiving coil **21** in the battery **22**. The vehicle control includes contactless charging control and automatic parking control.

(22) As illustrated in FIG. **3**, when the vehicle **3** in the parking lot **4** having a plurality of parking spaces **6** performs automatic parking, the user of the vehicle **3** from among the plurality of parking spaces **6** is selected it is possible to automatically park the vehicle **3** in any parking space **6**. In this case, the display device **25** can accept a selection operation by the user of the vehicle **3** in a state of displaying an image relating to a plurality of parking spaces **6**. That is, the display device **25** functions as an input unit to detect an operation input by the user. The vehicle ECU **23**, by detecting the inputting operation to the display device **25**, it is possible to determine the parking space **6** of the parking target.

(23) Further, in a state where the vehicle **3** is stopped in the parking space **6**, it is possible to perform non-contact charging using the power transmission device **10** and the power receiving device **20**. In the non-contact charging system **1**, non-contact charging from the power transmission device **10** to the vehicle **3** is performed in a state where wireless communication between the vehicle **3** and the power transmission device **10** is established. That is, the vehicle **3** performs pairing between the vehicle **3** and the power transmission device **10** by wireless communication using the communication device **24**, power is transmitted in a non-contact manner from the power transmission coil **11** on the ground side in a state of pairing is completed to the power receiving coil **21** of the vehicle **3** side. In the vehicle **3**, the control for supplying the power received by the power receiving coil **21** to the battery **22** is performed.

(24) Since the parking lot **4** is provided with a plurality of power transmission device **10**, the vehicle **3**, it is necessary to establish a pairing by selecting the communication of the power transmission device **10** installed in the parking space **6** to be parked own vehicle from a plurality of connection destinations. Therefore, when the vehicle **3** performs automatic parking, when the user selects the parking space **6** of the parking target from the input unit such as the display device **25**, the vehicle **3** refers to the map information including the radio communication information associated with the parking space **6**, the parking target It is configured to be able to automatically connect the wireless communication with the power transmission device **10** installed in the parking space **6**.

(25) Then, the vehicle **3** has a map information providing system for use in automatic operation, and has a function of adding additional information to the map information. The vehicle ECU **23** executes the automated driving control of the vehicle **3** using the map information provided by the map information providing system. The Map information providing system can add, for example, information indicating the presence or absence of the power supply facility **2** and wireless communication information of the power transmission device **10** corresponding to the parking space **6** in the parking lot **4** in the power supply facility **2** to the map information, as additional information. That is, the vehicle **3** can acquire the map information including the wireless communication information of the power transmission device **10**.

(26) FIG. **4** is a sequence diagram for explaining the control when the vehicle is automatically parked. The control illustrated in FIG. **4** is performed by the vehicle ECU **23**.

(27) The automatic parking control unit **31** detects that the parking space **6** of the parking target is

selected by the user of the vehicle **3** (Step S11). In Step S11, it is detected that the user's selection manipulation for the images displayed on the display device **25** of the vehicle **3** has been performed. That is, it is detected that the user has selected any parking space **6**. The automatic parking control unit **31** detects the selection operation, and outputs information about the selected parking space **6** (parking space information) to the non-contact charging control unit **32**. Then, the automatic parking control unit **31**, when outputting the parking space information, starts automatic parking control (Step S12).

(28) When the parking space information is inputted from the automatic parking control unit **31**, The non-contact charging control unit **32** collate between the map information including the wireless communication information associated with the parking space **6** and the parking space information (Step S13). In Step S13, the non-contact charging control unit **32** refers to the map information to identify the radio communication information associated with the power transmission device **10** installed in the parking space **6** to be parked.

(29) Further, when the vehicle **3** receives the radio wave signals from the plurality of power transmission devices **10**, the non-contact charging control unit **32** identifies the radio wave signal that matches the radio communication information identified in Step S12, and communicates with the power transmission device **10** that has transmitted the radio wave signal (Step S14). The non-contact charging control unit **32**, in a state where the wireless communication information associated with the parking space **6** of the parking target is identified, identifies the radio wave signal of the power transmission device **10** installed in the parking space **6** of the parking target from among a plurality of radio wave signals, and automatically selects the wireless communication with the power transmission device **10**. In Step S14, a radio wave signal selection and a communication connection of the power transmission device **10** in the parking space **6** is performed. Then, when the communication connection to the power transmission device **10** is completed, i.e. when the pairing with the power transmission device **10** is completed, the non-contact charging control unit **32** starts the non-contact charging control (Step S15).

(30) FIG. 5 is a flowchart for explaining the control when the vehicle is automatically parked. The control illustrated in FIG. 5 is implemented by the vehicle ECU **23**.

(31) The vehicle ECU **23** determines whether it has received a plurality of radio signals transmitted from the plurality of power transmission devices **10** (Step S21). If it is determined not to receive a plurality of radio waves transmitted from the plurality of power transmission devices **10** (Step S21: No), the control routine ends. If it is determined that it has received a plurality of radio wave signals transmitted from the plurality of power transmission devices **10** (Step S21: Yes), the vehicle ECU **23** selects the parking space **6** to automatically park (Step S22). The vehicle ECU **23** has a function of automatically parking in the parking space **6** selected by the user of the vehicle **3**, or has a function of automatically selecting a parking space **6** where to be stopped. The vehicle ECU **23** may have a function of automatically selecting a parking space **6** capable of non-contact charging.

(32) The vehicle ECU **23** acquires the radio communication information associated with the parking space **6** to be automatically parked from the map information (Step S23). In Step S23, in order to identify the radio communication information associated with the parking space **6** selected in Step S22, referring to the map information based on the parking space information, collation between the parking space information and the map information is performed. The vehicle ECU **23** automatically selects the radio wave signals of the power transmission device **10** installed in the parking space **6** of the parking target from among a plurality of radio wave signals (Step S24).

(33) Performing the process of S24 of steps, this control routine ends. As described above, according to the embodiment, it is possible to automatically connect the wireless communication with the power transmission device **10** installed in the parking space **6** of the parking target.

(34) Thus, when automatically parking the vehicle **3** in any parking space **6**, it is possible to realize the pairing of the power transmitting device **10** of the parking space **6** side and the power receiving device **20** of the vehicle **3** side in a simple manner.

(35) In the present disclosure, when automatically parking the vehicle in the parking space, it is possible to realize the pairing of the power transmission device and the vehicle-side power receiving device of the parking space side in a simple manner.

(36) According to an embodiment, when automatically parking the vehicle in the parking space, it is possible to realize the pairing of the power transmission device and the vehicle-side power receiving device of the parking space side in a simple manner.

(37) According to an embodiment, when receiving a plurality of radio wave signals transmitted from a plurality of power transmission device during automatic parking control, it is possible to automatically select the radio wave signals of the power transmission device installed in the parking space to be parked.

(38) Although the disclosure has been described with respect to specific embodiments for a complete and clear disclosure, the appended claims are not to be thus limited but are to be construed as embodying all modifications and alternative constructions that may occur to one skilled in the art that fairly fall within the basic teaching herein set forth.

Claims

1. A vehicle control device mounted on a vehicle, the vehicle control device having a map information-providing system for use in automatic operation and comprising: an automatic parking control unit that performs automatic parking control for automatically parking the vehicle in a parking space which is a parking target selected by a user of the vehicle from among a plurality of parking spaces provided in a parking lot, and a non-contact charging control unit that performs non-contact charging control for transmitting power from a power transmission device installed in the parking space to a power receiving device provided in the vehicle in a non-contact manner and stores the power in a battery mounted on the vehicle, wherein while the automatic parking control unit performs the automatic parking control, the non-contact charging control unit specifies radio communication information associated with the parking space of the parking target with reference to map information, and performs pairing between the power transmission device and the power receiving device by using the specified radio communication information, and the map information is provided by the map information-providing system and is used in an automated driving control of the vehicle, and the map information-providing system adds additional information to the map information, the additional information including at least the radio communication information of the power transmission device corresponding to the parking space.

2. A vehicle control device according to claim 1, wherein while the automatic parking control unit performs the automatic parking control, when the vehicle receives a plurality of radio wave signals transmitted from a plurality of power transmission devices, the non-contact charging control unit automatically selects a radio wave signal transmitted from the power transmission device installed in the parking space of the parking target on a basis of the specified radio communication information.
